

S04-E — Week 4 Synthesis: From the Collector to the Advisor's Own Pitch

Summary

Week four left behind the work-and-business territory covered in week three to return to the person who buys and the person who sells. Taken separately, the five entries seem to cover different topics: a framework of collector motivations, a listening method for first contact, a three-part structure for presenting a work, a catalog of answers to the most common objections, and finally, that same structure applied to the advisor herself. Taken together, they describe the full arc of a sales conversation, from understanding who is on the other side to knowing how to present oneself with the same evidentiary discipline a work demands. This note does not repeat the five lessons paragraph by paragraph, it orders them as successive stages of that conversation, so it can serve as a review map ahead of the exam.

1. Knowing who is on the other side

The whole arc of the week starts from a framework of four motivations that rarely appear in pure form in any one client: passionate interest in the work, decorative need, expectation of value appreciation, and the search for social belonging. The case that illustrates the passionate motivation at its fullest scale is [Eduardo F. Costantini, founder of the Museo de Arte Latinoamericano de Buenos Aires, who in December 2025 acquired the Daros Latinamerica collection, based in Zurich, 1,233 works by 117 artists](#), doubling in one stroke the holdings of the museum he himself founded.¹ In parallel, [Jorge M. Pérez donated 82 works from his personal collection to the Pérez Art Museum Miami that same month](#), a social and institutional variant of the same passionate motivation, with public projection inside the institutional ecosystem of his own city.² To that individual typology, the week added three operative axes for reading Latin American collectors up close: the family structure behind a purchase decision, the institutional density of the city of residence (Miami versus New York), and the confidence of negotiating in one's own language, the last one documented as a professional practice observation rather than external source data.

2. Opening the conversation without interrogating

Once the motivation at play is identified, the second stage is first contact. [Carola Wiese, senior art specialist at UBS Global Wealth Management, describes the good advisor as someone who studies, listens, and tries to stay objective, letting the client's own story reveal the information](#), instead of leading with a battery of direct questions or the advisor's own aesthetic taste.³ That listening method coexists with the operative conversion described by [David Schrader, Sotheby's head of private sales, who turns a vague interest into a brief of artist, series, year, size, color, and budget before activating a network of relationship managers](#) to locate the exact piece.⁴ Both methods share the same principle, letting information surface before forcing it, and differ only in the timescale on which they operate.

3. Presenting the work with reconstructible evidence

The third stage, once the conversation is open, is presenting an actual work. The two-minute pitch lesson fixes three parts in strict order, history, comparables, and why now, following the logic documented by [Dylan Lessel, co-director of Perrotin Second Marché, on building a file of auction results and comparables before communicating any valuation](#), so the client can reconstruct how the number was reached instead of accepting it on blind trust.⁵ The week's case is the Brazilian painter Adriana Varejão: her historical record of [GBP 1.1 million at Christie's London on February 16, 2011](#) was deliberately set aside in favor of the comparable that actually anchors the pitch, [Monocromo Redondo Ge, sold at Phillips London on June 8, 2026 for USD 374,100](#), reinforced by her representing Brazil at the [2026 Venice Biennale](#) as the institutional signal behind why now.⁶ The week's contrasting case, the Colombian sculptor Doris Salcedo, [named Art Icon by the Whitechapel Gallery in 2025](#) yet with an [auction record of only USD 665,000](#), showed that institutional recognition does not always translate into price.⁷

4. Holding the pitch under objection

The fourth stage assumes the presentation alone does not close the sale, and treats the objection as a request for proof rather than an obstacle. The same Varejão case is reinforced with a second comparable, [Monocromo redondo Guan, sold at Phillips New York on May 21, 2026 for USD 361,200](#), which together with the June result builds a defensible pattern across two different houses and cities.⁸ For the authenticity objection, the week returns to the episode of the painting attributed to Tarsila do Amaral, questioned at the SP-Arte fair in April 2024, where [a later appraisal declared it genuine with a new valuation](#), even though a member of the artist's family publicly rejected that conclusion, showing that not

even professional authentication fully closes the discussion.⁹ For the future-value objection, the joint study by [Bank of America and ArtTactic found an average annual return of 11% on works held between twenty and twenty-five years, against -5.7% for those sold before five years](#), a market average and not a projection for any specific piece.¹⁰

5. Presenting oneself with the same discipline

The final stage closes the arc by applying all of the above to the advisor herself. Based on [2025 year-end results, Sotheby's billed about 7.5 times what Phillips did and Christie's about 6.7 times](#), yet that scale gap does not stop [Phillips from holding the auction record of the sculptor Lygia Clark, USD 1,865,000 for *Bicho invertebrado* on November 21, 2013](#), alongside the already cited Salcedo record.¹¹ That institutional evidence is joined by a data point from a different segment of the business, 41% of buyers in [Phillips's Editions department during 2025 were new to the house](#).¹² The final contrast comes from independent advisor Evan Tawil, whose client base [grew through referrals thanks to responding quickly, communicating early what isn't viable, discarding non-viable requests early, and never reopening an already closed deal](#), conduct that does not depend on any institution's scale.¹³ Neither piece of evidence, institutional or behavioral, substitutes for the other.

For the Conversation with Clients

- Before presenting any work, it helps to identify which motivation from the week's framework dominates the specific conversation, without assuming it stays fixed for the whole relationship.
- Facing an objection, the professional answer delivers the same kind of reconstructible evidence the pitch requires, dated comparables for price, provenance documentation for authenticity, and market data, never projections, for future value.
- An advisor can cite their house's infrastructure as evidence of results, as long as it comes paired with concrete, time-verifiable behavioral commitments.

References

Process note: the live URL-verification fetch tool was blocked for the entire run today, tested against [www.sothebys.com](#), [en.wikipedia.org](#), and [www.artnews.com](#), all three returning EGRESS_BLOCKED, continuing the streak that began on 2026-08-10 (thirty-first consecutive day). WebSearch worked normally. The thirteen citations in this synthesis note reproduce exclusively sources already verified on 2026-08-08 in [curso/fuentes/dossier-01-precios-latam.md](#), [curso/fuentes/dossier-02-phillips.md](#), [curso/fuentes/](#)

dossier-03-coleccionistas.md, and curso/fuentes/dossier-07-tacticas-venta.md, plus The Art Newspaper article on Tarsila do Amaral and the Sotheby's and Phillips 2025 results releases, both already reused in this week's S04-L3, S04-L4, and S04-L5 notes, without introducing any URL not opened today. Today's fresh script data (the Armory Show's Focus section confirmation, curated by María Elena Ortiz, and Christie's first-half close at USD 4.5 billion) came from today's own WebSearch, each corroborated by multiple independent sources, not from fetch, which is why they carry no citation in this note, which is limited to the week's course content. The training radar did not apply today, it isn't Monday and none of PROMPT.md's three exception conditions were met. If a future run finds fetch working again, resume normal verification.

1. MALBA, [«Eduardo F. Costantini adquiere la Colección Daros Latinamerica»](#), verified in `curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md` on 2026-08-08. ↵
2. Pérez Art Museum Miami, [«Pérez Art Museum Miami Announces Major Collection Gift of 82 Works from Jorge M. Pérez»](#), verified in `curso/fuentes/dossier-03-coleccionistas.md` on 2026-08-08. ↵
3. Art Basel, [«Art advisor Carola Wiese on breaking her own number one rule of art fair advice»](#), 2024-06-03, verified in `curso/fuentes/dossier-07-tacticas-venta.md` on 2026-08-08. ↵
4. Sotheby's, [«Privacy Please, The Ins and Outs of Buying and Selling Art Privately»](#), interview with David Schrader, 2020-03-24, verified in `curso/fuentes/dossier-07-tacticas-venta.md` on 2026-08-08. ↵
5. Talking Galleries, *Barcelona Symposium 2022*, interview with Dylan Lessel, Perrotin Second Marché, 2022-10-03/04, [Talking Galleries](#). ↵
6. HENI News, Adriana Varejão market profile, Phillips London result of 2026-06-08, [HENI](#); The Art Newspaper, *Women artists lead the way in Brazil*, 2013-09-01, [The Art Newspaper](#); La Biennale di Venezia, 2026 art edition, [La Biennale di Venezia](#). ↵
7. White Cube, Doris Salcedo artist page, Whitechapel Gallery Art Icon designation, 2025-03-03, [White Cube](#); Phillips, Doris Salcedo artist page, auction results, [Phillips](#). ↵
8. Phillips, *Modern & Contemporary Art Afternoon Sale*, New York, 2026-05-21, Adriana Varejão lot, *Monocromo redondo Guan*, USD 361,200, [Phillips](#). ↵
9. The Art Newspaper, *Tarsila do Amaral forgery claims at SP-Arte*, 2024-04-08, [The Art Newspaper](#). ↵

10. Bank of America and ArtTactic, *U.S. Art Market Report 2026*, annualized return data by holding period, [Bank of America](#). ↵
11. Sotheby's, «Sotheby's Projects 2025 Consolidated Sales of \$7 Billion» press release (2025-12-17), [Sotheby's](#); Phillips, Latin America sale results release, New York, November 2013, [Phillips](#). ↵
12. Phillips Editions, 2025 buyer data, [Phillips](#). ↵
13. Artnet News, '*Honesty Saves Time*': *Why Top Collectors Come to Advisor Evan Tawil*, 2023-10-20, [Artnet](#). ↵